

Mei Zhou

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PRESENT POSITION

Dissertation Year Fellow
The University of Hong Kong

Expected: Feb 2027

EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong

Ph.D. in Cognitive Neuroscience

Hong Kong SAR

2021–2025

Dissertation: Probabilistic Memory Prioritization Mechanisms in Statistical Learning

Committees: Shelley Xiuli Tong (Supervisor), Matthew Leonard, Tom Verguts, Yuanwei Yao

Zhejiang University

B.Sc. in Psychology and Behavioral Sciences

Hangzhou, China

2017–2021

Dissertation: Unconscious Processing of Social Interaction Information

AWARDS AND GRANTS

The University of Hong Kong Dissertation Year Fellowship (HK\$340,800)

Mar 2026

The University of Hong Kong Research Postgraduate Student Publication Award (HK\$5,000)

Oct 2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Statistical learning

Working memory

Memory prioritization

Cognitive neuroscience

Computational modeling

Developmental science

Developmental dyslexia

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

1. Tong, S. X., Zhang, P., **Zhou, M.**, & Ziegler, J. (2026). How uncertainty affects children's exploration and exploitation in statistical learning. *Developmental Science*, 29(4), e70235. <https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.70235>
IF = 4.2; Citations = 0; Q1 in Developmental and Educational Psychology.
2. An, N., **Zhou, M.**, Ziegler, J. C., & Tong, S. X. (2026). The impact of working memory on Chinese word reading: The respective roles of quality and quantity. *Scientific Studies of Reading*, 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10888438.2026.2659583>

IF = 3.8; Citations = 0; Q1 in Education.

3. **Zhou, M., & Tong, S. X.** (2025). Statistical learning prioritizes abstract over item-specific representations. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 32, 3264–3275. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-025-02757-8>

IF = 4.2; Citations = 2; Ranked 13/169 (Q1) in Experimental and Cognitive Psychology.

4. **Zhou, M., Zhang, P., Mimeau, C., & Tong, S. X.** (2024). Unravelling the complex interplay between statistical learning and working memory in Chinese children with and without dyslexia across different ages. *Child Development*, 95(5), e338–e351. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.14121>

IF = 5.0; Citations = 16; Ranked 7/60 (Q1) in Educational Psychology.

5. Fu, Y., **Zhou, M.**, Zhou, J., Shen, M., & Chen, H. (2024). Unconscious prioritization for face-to-face people. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 153(5), 1268–1280. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001556>

IF = 4.5; Citations = 12; Ranked 8/102 (Q1) in Experimental Psychology.

Manuscripts Under Review

6. **Zhou, M., & Tong, S. X.** (2026). Temporal dynamics of probability and structure representations during statistical learning. *Manuscript under review*.
7. **Zhou, M., & Tong, S. X.** (2026). Predictive priority shapes human statistical learning in multi-regularity environments. *Manuscript under review*.
8. Guo, Q., Wang, X., **Zhou, M.**, & Tong, S. X. (2026). Neurophysiological signatures of statistical learning: An EEG meta-analysis. *Manuscript under review*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Note: presenter

Symposium Talks

1. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Sep 2026). “The Dynamic Interplay Between Conditional and Distributional Statistical Learning.” Symposium: “Unravelling the Cognitive Mechanisms of Learning Across the Lifespan.” *The Joint ESCoP-CoPM Meeting 2026*. [Symposium Chair]

Oral Presentations

2. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Jun 2022). “The Development of Statistical Learning and Working Memory in Chinese Children With and Without Dyslexia.” *The International Conference on Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*.

Posters

3. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Jun 2026). “Distinct Neural Representations of Probability for Abstract and Item-Specific Information During Statistical Learning.” *The International Conference on Interdisciplinary Advances in Statistical Learning*.
4. **Zhou, M.**, Tong, S. X. (Dec 2025). “Abstract Over Item-Specific Information: Statistical Learning Optimizes Memory Representation.” *The 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

TEACHING

Guest Lecture, The University of Hong Kong

Feb 2026

Replication Crisis in Psychological Research

PHIL2140: Philosophy of Social Science

ADVISING

- Exploring the Mind: Cognitive Science Experimenter Training** Fall 2026
Speech, Language, and Reading Lab, The University of Hong Kong
Jeffrey Chan, Sabrina Yiu Yiu Choi, Alice Kwan Yin Hung, Angus Tsz Fung Yan, Yui Hin Ng, Hannah Hanxue Wu, Esme Ziyuan Yang
- Speech, Language, and Reading Lab**
The University of Hong Kong 2021-present
Supervise for over 6 undergraduate and graduate research interns

WORKSHOPS

- Statistical Tests in Psychological Studies** Aug 2026
Speech, Language, and Reading Lab, The University of Hong Kong
Presenter
- Scoring Guide for Torrance Tests of Creativity Thinking** Oct 2023
Speech, Language, and Reading Lab, The University of Hong Kong
Organizer and Presenter

RESEARCH TRAINING

- The University of Hong Kong** 2021-present
Graduate student
Supervisor: Prof. Shelley Xiuli Tong
- Zhejiang University** 2020-2021
Undergraduate student
Supervisor: Prof. Hui Chen
- Zhejiang University** May 2020
Undergraduate research assistant
Supervisor: Prof. Zaifeng Gao
Project: Human Reliability for Intelligent Manufacturing
- Peking University** December 2019
Undergraduate research assistant
Supervisor: Prof. Yang Bai
Project: Emotional Perception in Workspace Situations

SKILLS

- Experimental methods:** Behavioral experiments, eye tracking, EEG
- Statistical analysis:** Generalized linear mixed models, Bayesian analysis, ANOVA, factor analysis, item response theory analysis
- EEG analysis:** ERP, time-frequency, representational similarity analysis, phase-amplitude coupling
- Computational modeling:** Bayesian knowledge tracing, hierarchical Bayesian modeling, machine learning
- Programming:** R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX
- Languages:** Chinese (native), English (professional proficiency)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Psychonomic Society	2024-present
Cognitive Science Society	2025-present